

MAJOR IS MINOR

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #142

We know that major sounds (1 - 3 - 5) and minor sounds (1 - b3 - 5) are musical opposites. They are like happy and sad, high and low. But they are also very closely related (Google "relative major and minor"). It turns out that if we know a lick, a melody, a device in a major key, there is a good chance that it'll work pretty well in the relative minor key.

In other words, a great melody in C major might work well in it's relative minor key of A minor. Below, we use the song "On A Clear Day" as such an example. And, if we want to get really fancy, we can also loosen up our definition of relative minor and find "other relative minors" in the modes of C major, such as D minor, or E minor.

What does all this mean? It means many of your major licks ARE minor licks. And those minor licks of yours . . . are major licks! You just doubled your lick inventory.

#1 - "On A Clear Day" in C major



#2 - Same notes over A minor



#3 - Same notes over E minor



#4 - Same notes over D minor



#5 - First 4 measureas of "Green Dolphin St."

